

# Evgenii Zaitsev

## Product Manager · B2B and B2C

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Saint Petersburg · Russian / English · Technical background

## PMP (PMI, 2023) · Certified ScrumMaster (2023) · HSE: Master in Management, professional education with distinction

At Samolet, I develop CRM products for sales teams. In my own venture, EmTalk, I work with the team on apps for mental well-being and decision-making. I started as an engineer, so I look at both the user's problem and how a solution works. My cases describe the decisions I made, the actions I took and where the team got to.

## Experience & responsibility

### Samolet | Apr 2026 - present

Product Manager · Internal CRM products

With the team, reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to 2 weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. Responsible for two internal CRM products. Built an analytics product with AI assistance, using Python and Streamlit for dashboards and ClickHouse data analysis.

- Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify blockers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes.
- Designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements: user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development.

### EmTalk | Feb 2023 - present

Founder / Product Owner

Conducted 50+ customer discovery interviews during research and built a team without an initial budget. Together, released BRET and Decision Matrix on Google Play.

- Defined product strategy, requirements, backlog and priorities.
- Conducted user, market and competitor research; prepared business model and GTM materials.

### Freelance / Project engagements | Jun 2023 - Nov 2024

Project / Product Manager

WinLab: Senior Project Manager (outstaff), assortment, checkout and 1C reporting. Kickidler: team diagnosis, roadmap and analytics; TTM halved and LTV rose 20% (self-reported).

- WinLab: with the team, moved the assortment project to business and functional requirements; secured contractor priority for the checkout project. 1C reporting reached a test launch before I left.
- Kickidler: diagnosed delivery and requirements, prepared a change plan, and used RACI, MoSCoW and a roadmap.

### Statistics & Control / Statcontrol | Jul 2019 - Feb 2023

Technical Product Owner / Project Manager

OptiRamp: discovery, digital twins, forecasting and implementation. Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS and migration automation.

- Worked with Russian and international clients from presales and problem discovery through OptiRamp implementation and testing.
- Introduced Kanban and task evaluation, improved feedback and engineer onboarding.

### Gazprom avtomatizatsia | Oct 2017 - Jul 2019

Team Leader

Control systems for gas turbines and gas transport facilities. Engineering and on-site team leadership, including assignments beyond the Arctic Circle.

- Developed control software; contributed to commissioning, FAT and SAT.
- Coordinated the team and delivery, prepared project documentation.

## Product stories

### **Samolet: from user friction to faster delivery**

Two CRM products, a newly assembled team and low adoption. I started with discovery and priority fixes, then changed requirements, early QA involvement and analytics.

#### **Context and priorities**

I joined a newly assembled team in April 2026. Sales users often chose other tools. Through customer discovery and conversations with sales managers and regional leads, I identified workflow blockers and prioritised fixes.

#### **Discovery and delivery decisions**

I designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements using user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development. We involved QA earlier and introduced human-reviewed AI-generated test cases, automation and SDD.

#### **How a data gap led to a new product**

The team needed data to make decisions, but had no product analyst, and preparing reports was difficult. With AI assistance, I built an analytics product in Python and Streamlit to create dashboards and analyse ClickHouse data. When a product analyst joined, they adopted the approach. The product remains in use and has become essential to analytics for internal products.

#### **Team results**

We reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. My contribution covered priorities, requirements, early QA involvement and stakeholder collaboration. These were shared results of process changes, not the effect of a single tool.

#### **Work still in progress**

Adoption remains a challenge: product metrics have started to improve but are still weak. We continue root-cause analysis and work on workflows and usage habits. Faster delivery alone does not establish product success.

[Read the case online](#)

### **EmTalk: from research to two apps**

I build a project focused on mental well-being and decision-making. Together with the team, we moved from customer discovery to BRET, Decision Matrix and a content website.

#### **Starting point**

During research, conducted more than 50 customer discovery interviews and studied the market and competitors. Built a part-time team without an initial budget to explore useful well-being and decision-making scenarios.

#### **My role and actions**

Founder and product lead: strategy, market and competitor research, requirements, backlog, prioritisation and team coordination. I prepared the pitch deck, investor materials and a go-to-market plan.

#### **From research to release**

Together with the team, brought BRET and Decision Matrix to publication on Google Play. The EmTalk website offers five tests and nine articles, including an article with an audio version.

#### **The products**

BRET brings together well-being practices. Decision Matrix helps compare options: its official listing describes categories, Pros & Cons, decision history and AI suggestions for alternatives.

#### **What this experience demonstrates**

Founder experience across the product cycle: research, strategy, team coordination and release. My contribution is product and organisational work; the apps and website are a team outcome.

[Read the case online](#)

## Systems, teams & approach

### WinLab: complex projects and stakeholder management

#### Flexible assortment matrix

The project aimed to expand regional assortments through local producers and create an opportunity for revenue growth. Discussions with the main stakeholder were tense. I temporarily paused direct communication with them, involved a wider group of stakeholders and heard other perspectives. We then brought leadership into the work. Together with the team, we moved the project to preparing business and functional requirements.

#### Checkout system and Kafka

Another project involved moving the checkout system from a monolith to microservices and Kafka. My task was to secure priority with contractor Kristall and keep the project on schedule. I challenged their project managers' position using project management practices and set out my next steps. Within a few hours, they accepted my position; the contractor prioritised the project.

#### 1C reporting automation

The main challenge here was working with the business stakeholder. During one project meeting, the accounting team broke off the discussion and left. I had to use escalation. The project progressed during my engagement: a test launch took place before I left.

[Read the case online](#)

### Kickidler: From team diagnosis to delivery changes

#### Context and my work

At Kickidler, I diagnosed delivery, requirements and collaboration problems. I introduced a roadmap, used RACI and MoSCoW, and prepared an analyst template and a change plan.

#### Results

Based on my assessment, TTM halved and LTV increased by 20%. There were fewer bugs; analytics, motivation and team eNPS improved. Comparison periods and TTM/LTV methods are not provided here. These are team results, not the effect of one recommendation.

[Read the case online](#)

## Further experience & skills

### Statistics & Control: Turning complex systems into manageable work

#### Context

Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS reverse engineering and scripts for equipment-version migrations. Later moved to OptiRamp, digital twins, forecasting and modelling for Russian and international clients.

#### My role and actions

Coordinated the team and delivery; worked on requirements, risks and presales. Introduced Kanban, task evaluation, feedback and engineer onboarding processes. Prepared proposals for organisational transformation.

#### Consulting and analytical justification

In my 2022 HSE final project, developed an organisational transformation proposal: current and future reality trees, SWOT, a role model and pilot plan. Modelled costs, NPV and payback, and analysed schedule risks with Monte Carlo simulation in Primavera Risk Analysis. This is an assumption-based proposal and forecast, not verified savings.

[Read the case online](#)

## Skills & tools

Discovery, customer development, stakeholder management, roadmap, Scrum, Kanban. Consulting, business analysis, financial modelling. ClickHouse, Streamlit, ICONIX, PlantUML, AI, SDD. Jira, Figma, PostgreSQL. Python: basic. Russian: native. English: self-assessed B2+/C1.

## Education & learning

Peter the Great St Petersburg Polytechnic University - Technical education, master's studies · 2009-2015

HSE · Master in Management - Professional education programme, with distinction · 2021-2022

PMP / Certified ScrumMaster - PMI / Scrum Alliance · 2023

Machine Learning / Deep Learning - SkillFactory · 2022